

DoangJoo "Alan" Synn

PhD Candidate in Computer Science · Georgia Institute of Technology

Advised by [Prof. HyunJoo Oh](#) and [Prof. Sehoon Ha](#)

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Research Interests

I study **motion** as a computational medium across HCI and computer graphics. My research builds systems for designing, generating, and fabricating motion. I aim to make motion programmable and tangible across animated characters, mechanical artifacts, robotic systems, and AI-assisted creative tools.

Education

Georgia Tech, Ph.D. in Computer Science

2022 – Present

- Atlanta, GA, USA
- [School of Interactive Computing](#); advised by Profs. [Oh](#) & [Ha](#)
- Research: computational design, automata, and motion synthesis (Graphics/HCI)

Korea University, M.Eng. in ECE

2020 – 2022

- Seoul, Korea
- Advised by [Prof. Jong-Kook Kim](#)
- GPA: 4.25 (4.5 scale)
- Thesis: *On Efficient Data Delivery for Machine Learning Systems*

Korea University, B.Eng. in EE

2012 – 2020

- Seoul, Korea
- GPA: 3.56 (4.5 scale)
- On leave from 2016 Spring to 2019 Spring to serve alternative military service

Experience

PhD Research Intern, Dolby Laboratories

2024 – 2025

- Atlanta, GA, USA
- Experience Delivery Lab, built a time-series, multimodal datastore supporting low-latency media analytics.

MLOps Engineering Intern, LG Uplus Corp.

2023

- Seoul, Korea
- Led **DeepCrunch**, a model-compression library with multi-backend AI inference for efficient edge serving.

Research Scientist, Protopia AI Inc.

2021 – 2022

- Austin, TX, USA
- Built **Stained-Glass**, a privacy-preserving deep-learning framework enabling inference without raw-data exposure.
- Led development and infrastructure integration (Kubernetes + GPU).
- CEO: [Dr. Ebrahimi](#); CTO: [Prof. Esmaeilzadeh](#).

- Resulted in a NeurIPS 2021 Demo publication.

Cloud Architect · AWS Educate Cloud Ambassador

2020 – 2022

- Seoul, Korea
- Guided 4 startups to cloud-native deployments (Kubernetes, Terraform) and shipped their services.
- Led CI/CD, observability, and cost-optimized autoscaling for social-media back-ends.

Server Engineer, Flysher Inc.

2019

- Seoul, Korea
- Shipped back-end features for 4 social-game titles; one reached global top-10 on Facebook.
- Built an ETL → Redshift analytics pipeline driving data-informed feature rollout.

System Engineer, AKA Intelligence (Musio)

2017 – 2019

- Seoul, Korea
- Designed embedded Linux boards & firmware for the social robot **Musio**.
- Coordinated HW-SW integration and production QA with overseas ODMs.

Selected Publications

- 1 **D. Synn**, Z. Guo, S. Ha, and H. Oh, “MotionSmith: A Sketch-Based Design System for Automata Making,” *CHI*, Apr. 2026.
- 2 J. Yu, P. Garg, **D. Synn**, and H. Oh, “Tangible-MakeCode: Bridging Physical Coding Blocks with a Web-Based Programming Interface for Collaborative and Extensible Learning,” *CHI*, Apr. 2025.
- 3 M. Ryu, X. Piao, J. Park, **D. Synn**, and J. Kim, “ADaPT: An Automated Dataloader Parameter Tuning Framework using AVL Tree-based Search Algorithms,” *TKIPS*, Jan. 2025.
- 4 **D. Synn**, X. Piao, J. Park, and J. Kim, “Distributed Training of Deep Learning Models Using Micro Batch Streaming,” *KTSDE*, Mar. 2023.
- 5 X. Piao, **D. Synn**, J. Park, and J. Kim, “Enabling large batch size training for dnn models beyond the memory limit while maintaining performance,” *IEEE Access*, 2023.
- 6 J. Han, **D. Synn**, T. Kim, H. Jung, and J. Kim, “Feature Based Sampling: A Fast and Robust Sampling Method for Tasks Using 3D Point Cloud,” *IEEE Access*, Apr. 2022.
- 7 **D. Synn** and J. Kim, “Num Worker Tuner: An Automated Spawn Parameter Tuner for Multi-Processing DataLoaders,” *ACK*, Oct. 2021.
- 8 J. Park, **D. Synn**, and J. Kim, “A Survey on the Advancement of Virtualization Technology,” *KIPS*, May 2021.
- 9 B. Ahn, **D. Synn**, M. Derkani, E. Ebrahimi, and H. Esmaeilzadeh, “Protopia AI: Taking on the Missing Link in AI Privacy and Data Protection,” *NeurIPS*, 2021.
- 10 D. Kim, **D. Synn**, and J. Kim, “SG-Drop: Faster Skip-Gram by Dropping Context Words,” *KIPS*, Nov. 2020.